

Azeez Alishah Hussain Syed

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◦ Summary ◦

Passionate about cloud-native networking and open DNS infrastructure, I actively contribute to CNCF projects like Cilium and CoreDNS. My recent work includes Gateway API fixes in Cilium, standards-compliant DNS logic in CoreDNS, and improving OSS developer workflows with custom issue templates. I take a hands-on, RFC-driven approach to systems programming, exploring Kubernetes internals, DNS protocols, and eBPF with precision and curiosity.

◦ Skills ◦

Go Programming Language, Python, Kubernetes, CNCF Ecosystem, Linux Networking, Git + GitHub, PR workflows

◦ Volunteering ◦

Swecha Foundation

Promoted open source and digital freedom through local projects and collaboration.

CNCF Hyderabad

Participated in meetups focused on Kubernetes, eBPF, and cloud-native tooling.

Kubernetes Community Days (KCD)

Engaged with the broader Kubernetes ecosystem through talks and discussions.

◦ Education ◦

Andhra University

Computer Application
Masters

Narayana College
BA

Experience

Cilium

Contributor

Cilium – Cloud Native Networking, Security & Observability

Contributor · March 2025 – Present

GitHub: [@syedazeez337](#)

Contributed upstream fixes and documentation to improve Gateway API behavior and policy clarity. Changes have been merged and backported into official Cilium releases.

Key Contributions

- [#38874](#): Fixed Gateway reconciler crash when ``TLSRoute`` CRD is missing
→ Added cluster capability check and fallback logic
- [#39275](#): Corrected ``parentRefMatched`` to validate ``Group`` and ``Kind``
→ Prevented incorrect attachment of unrelated ``Service`` parentRefs
- [#40272](#): Documented ``egressDeny`` in ``CiliumNetworkPolicy``
→ Included tested YAML examples and clarified precedence rules

Release Inclusion

- Backported to ``v1.17.4`` ([#39377](#))
- Included in ``v1.18.0-pre.2`` and ``v1.18.0-pre.3``

CoreDNS

Contributor

CoreDNS – DNS Server for Cloud-Native Environments

Contributor · July 2025 – Present

GitHub: [@syedazeez337](#)

Fixed standards compliance issues in DNS record handling to improve test reliability and protocol correctness.

Key Contributions

- [#7413](#): Fixed TXT record comparison logic
→ Distinguished between multi-string and multi-record TXT entries (RFC 1035)
→ Updated test plugin logic and added regression test coverage
- [#7402](#): Preserved case in SRV record names and targets
→ Aligned with [RFC 6763 §4.1.1](#) for service discovery compatibility
→ Added test zone validation using ``dig``

Community Contributions

GaijinEntertainment

Contributor · June 2025

GitHub: [@syedazeez337](#)

Improved issue tracking workflows by adding a standardized bug report template.

Key Contribution

- [#117](#): Added custom bug report template under ``github/ISSUE_TEMPLATE``
→ Authored ``config.yml`` and ``bug_report.yml`` with structured fields for reproducible reports
→ Enhanced triage quality and developer feedback loop